SYSTEM DOCUMENTATION

Library Management System

User guide, administration guide and technical reference for members, librarians and administrators.

VERSION	DATE	PLATFORM
1.0	13 November 2026	Laravel 13 · Livewire 4 · Tailwind CSS 4

Contents

1. Introduction . . . 3

1.1 Purpose of this document . . . 3

1.2 Intended audience . . . 3

1.3 System at a glance . . . 3

1.4 Conventions used . . . 4

2. Getting started . . . 5

2.1 Requirements . . . 5

2.2 Installation . . . 5

2.3 Running the system . . . 5

2.4 Demo accounts . . . 6

2.5 Signing in . . . 6

2.6 Creating a member account . . . 7

3. Getting around the interface . . . 9

3.1 The sidebar . . . 9

3.2 Buttons, icons and colours . . . 9

3.3 Toast notifications . . . 10

3.4 Using the system on a phone . . . 11

4. Member guide . . . 13

4.1 My library . . . 13

4.2 Renewing a loan . . . 14

4.3 Searching the catalogue . . . 14

4.4 Book details . . . 15

4.5 Reserving a book . . . 16

5. Librarian guide . . . 17

5.1 The desk dashboard . . . 17

5.2 Issuing a book . . . 18

5.3 Returning a book . . . 18

5.4 Managing books . . . 19

5.5 Managing members . . . 21

5.6 Reservations . . . 22

5.7 Fines and payments . . . 23

6. Administrator guide . . . 25

6.1 Reports . . . 25
6.2 Librarian accounts . . . 26
6.3 Library rules . . . 27
7. Library rules and how lending works . . . 29
7.1 Configurable rules . . . 29
7.2 Availability . . . 29
7.3 Fines . . . 29
7.4 Reservation life cycle . . . 30
7.5 Removing records . . . 30
8. Roles and permissions . . . 31
8.1 Permission matrix . . . 31
8.2 How access is enforced . . . 31
9. Technical reference . . . 32
9.1 Technology stack . . . 32
9.2 Architecture . . . 32
9.3 Project structure . . . 32
9.4 Screens and URLs . . . 33
9.5 Interface components . . . 34
10. Data model . . . 35
10.1 Tables . . . 35
10.2 Relationships . . . 35
11. Notifications and scheduled tasks . . . 36
11.1 Notifications . . . 36
11.2 The daily task . . . 36
12. Security, testing and support . . . 37
12.1 Security measures . . . 37
12.2 Automated tests . . . 37
12.3 Troubleshooting . . . 38
12.4 Known limitations . . . 38
13. Appendix: list of figures . . . 39

CHAPTER 1

1. Introduction

The Library Management System is a web application that replaces a manual library of paper registers and stamp cards with software that tracks books, members, loans, reservations and fines. At any moment it answers three questions: **What books do we have? Who has which book? Who owes what?**

1.1 Purpose of this document

This document describes the system for everyone who uses, runs or maintains it. It explains every screen with screenshots taken from the running application, the library rules the system enforces, how access is controlled, how the data is organised, and how to install, operate and test the system.

1.2 Intended audience

Reader	Chapters to read
Members (students and staff)	3 Getting around the interface, 4 Member guide
Librarians	3, 4 and 5 Librarian guide, 7 Library rules
Administrators	All user chapters, plus 6 Administrator guide and 8 Roles and permissions
Developers and IT support	9 Technical reference to 12 Troubleshooting

1.3 System at a glance

Area	What the system provides
Catalogue	Search by title, author or ISBN; filter by category or by "available now"; book details with live availability.
Circulation	Issue and return books at the desk, with a live preview of the member's limit and the book's availability.
Reservations	A first-come, first-served queue. Returned copies are held for the next member and they are notified.
Fines	Calculated automatically from days late and the daily rate; payments recorded at the desk.
Reports	Totals, most borrowed books, loans per month, overdue books and fine collection.
Administration	Librarian accounts and the library rules (loan period, fines, limits, hold period).
Automation	A daily task sends due and overdue reminders and releases uncollected holds.

1.4 Conventions used

- **Bold** text names a button, menu item or field exactly as it appears on screen.
- `Monospace` text is a command, URL, permission or database value.
- Amounts are in Kenyan shillings (KES). Screenshots use sample data; names and figures are illustrative.

CHAPTER 2

2. Getting started

This chapter covers installing the system, starting it, and signing in for the first time.

2.1 Requirements

Component	Version
PHP	8.3 or newer (developed on 8.4)
Composer	2.x
Node.js and npm	Current LTS, used to build the CSS and JavaScript
Database	SQLite by default; MySQL, MariaDB, PostgreSQL or SQL Server also work
Web browser	Any current Chrome, Edge, Firefox or Safari, on desktop or phone

2.2 Installation

```
git clone git@github.com:Meshack-pi/library.git
cd library

composer install
cp .env.example .env
php artisan key:generate

touch database/database.sqlite
php artisan migrate --seed

npm install
npm run build
```

`php artisan migrate --seed` creates the tables, the three roles with their permissions, 22 sample books in six categories, and the demo accounts listed below.

2.3 Running the system

For development, start the web server and the asset builder together, then open `http://localhost:8000`:

```
composer run dev
```

To serve only the already-built assets:

```
php artisan serve
```

To reset everything back to the sample data:

```
php artisan migrate:fresh --seed
```

2.4 Demo accounts

Role	Sign in with	Password	Lands on
Administrator	admin@library.test	password	Reports
Librarian	librarian@library.test	password	Desk
Member	member@library.test or admission number ADM001	password	My library

Security: change or remove the demo accounts before the system holds real data.

2.5 Signing in

The sign-in page accepts either an email address or a member's admission number. After signing in, each person is taken straight to the home page for their role.

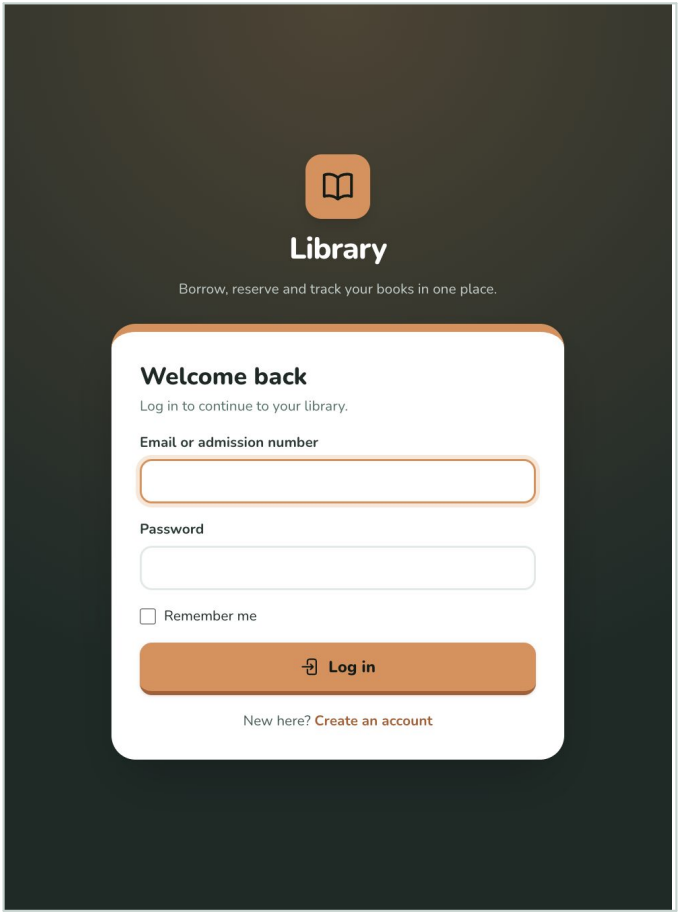


Figure 1: The sign-in screen

If the details are wrong the form says so beneath the field. After five failed attempts from the same address the form is locked for a short time to slow down password guessing.

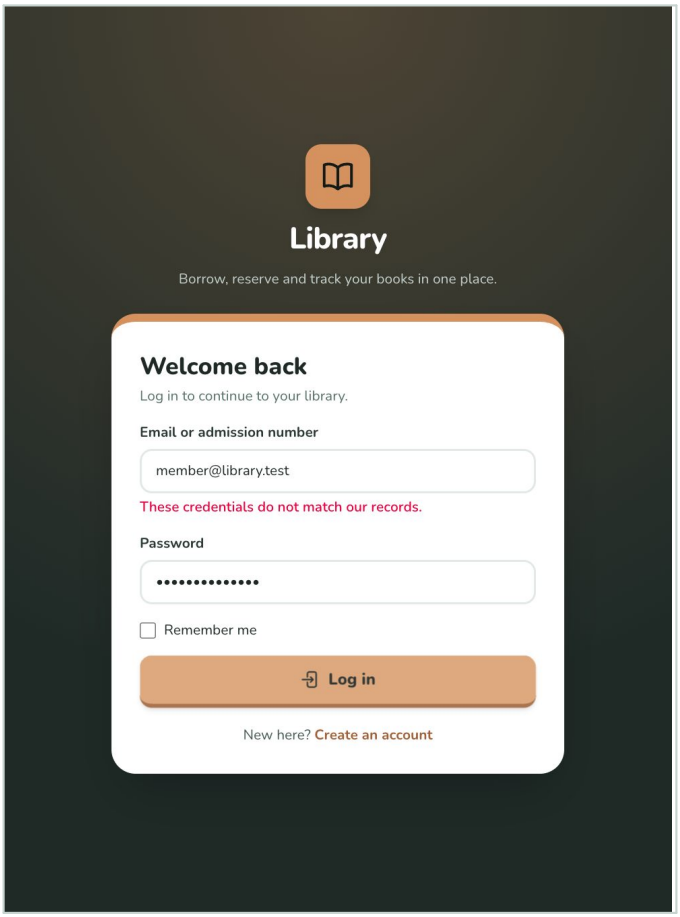


Figure 2: A failed sign-in shows a clear message under the field

2.6 Creating a member account

New students and staff can register themselves from **Create an account**. Self-registration always creates a *member*; librarian accounts can only be created by an administrator. The admission or staff number is optional but lets the member sign in with it and lets the librarian find them quickly at the desk.

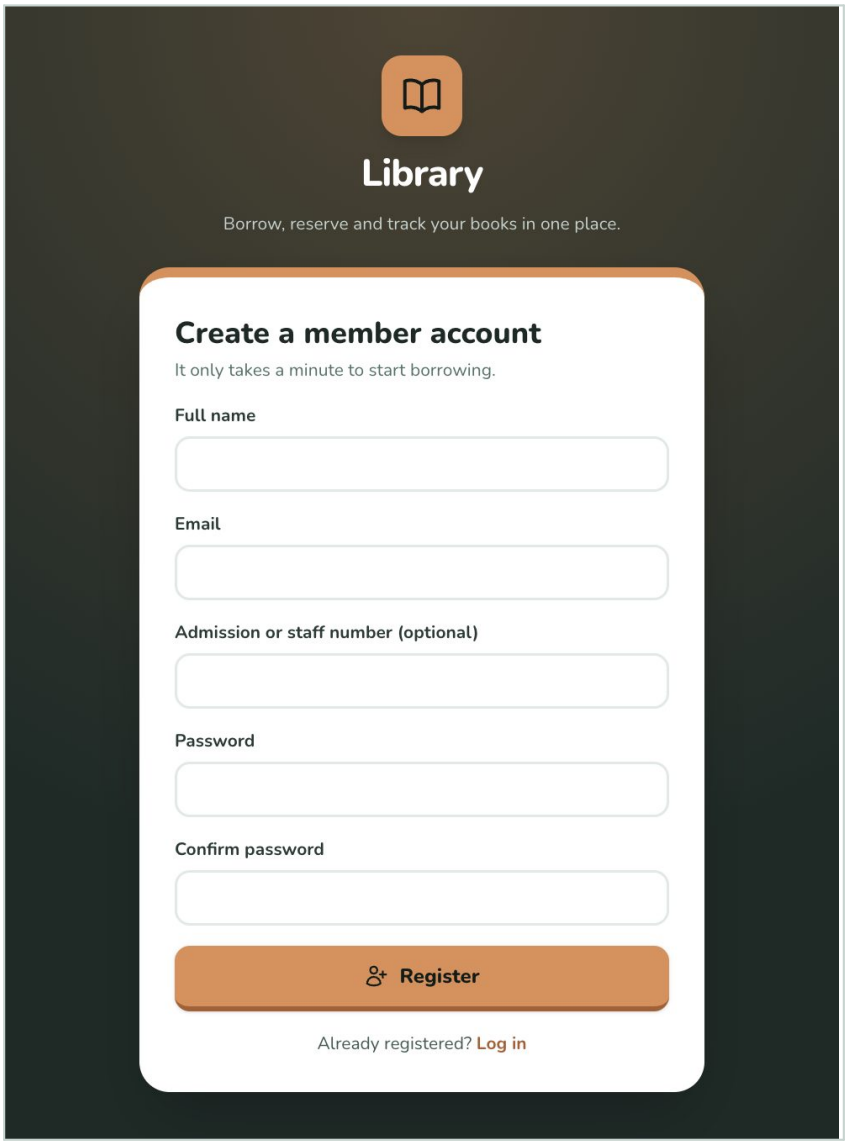


Figure 3: The registration screen

CHAPTER 3

3. Getting around the interface

Every signed-in screen shares the same layout: a dark sidebar on the left for navigation and the page content on the right. The design uses three brand colours (deep ink **#1F2A27**, warm copper **#D6925E** and white) with red reserved for warnings and destructive actions.

3.1 The sidebar

The sidebar groups pages by task so the next action is always one click away. A person only sees the links their role is allowed to open.

Group	Pages	Who sees it
My account	My library	Members
Browse	Catalogue	Everyone
Circulation	Desk, Issue / Return, Reservations, Fines	Librarians and administrators
Manage	Books, Members	Librarians and administrators
Administration	Reports, Librarians, Rules	Administrators

- The current page is highlighted in white with a copper icon tile.
- The card at the bottom shows who is signed in and their role.
- **Log out** is a large button at the bottom of the sidebar.

3.2 Buttons, icons and colours

Buttons are large with a raised bottom edge that presses down when clicked, and each carries an icon that matches its action. The colour tells you what kind of action it is:

Button style	Meaning	Examples
Copper (primary)	The main action on the screen	Issue book, Add book, Reserve, Renew, Log in
Ink (dark)	Confirming or saving	Save book, Save member, Return, Record payment, Save rules
White (secondary)	A safe, secondary action	Edit, Cancel (closing a form), Mark all as read
Red (danger)	Removes or cancels something	Remove, Remove access, Cancel reservation

Status badges use the same idea: green for *on time* or *ready to collect*, copper for *due today*, *waiting* or *borrowed*, and red for *overdue* or *at limit*.

3.3 Toast notifications

After an action the system confirms what happened with a toast that slides in at the top right. Toasts close themselves after five seconds (a bar along the bottom shows the time left) and can be dismissed early with the × button. Screen readers announce them automatically.

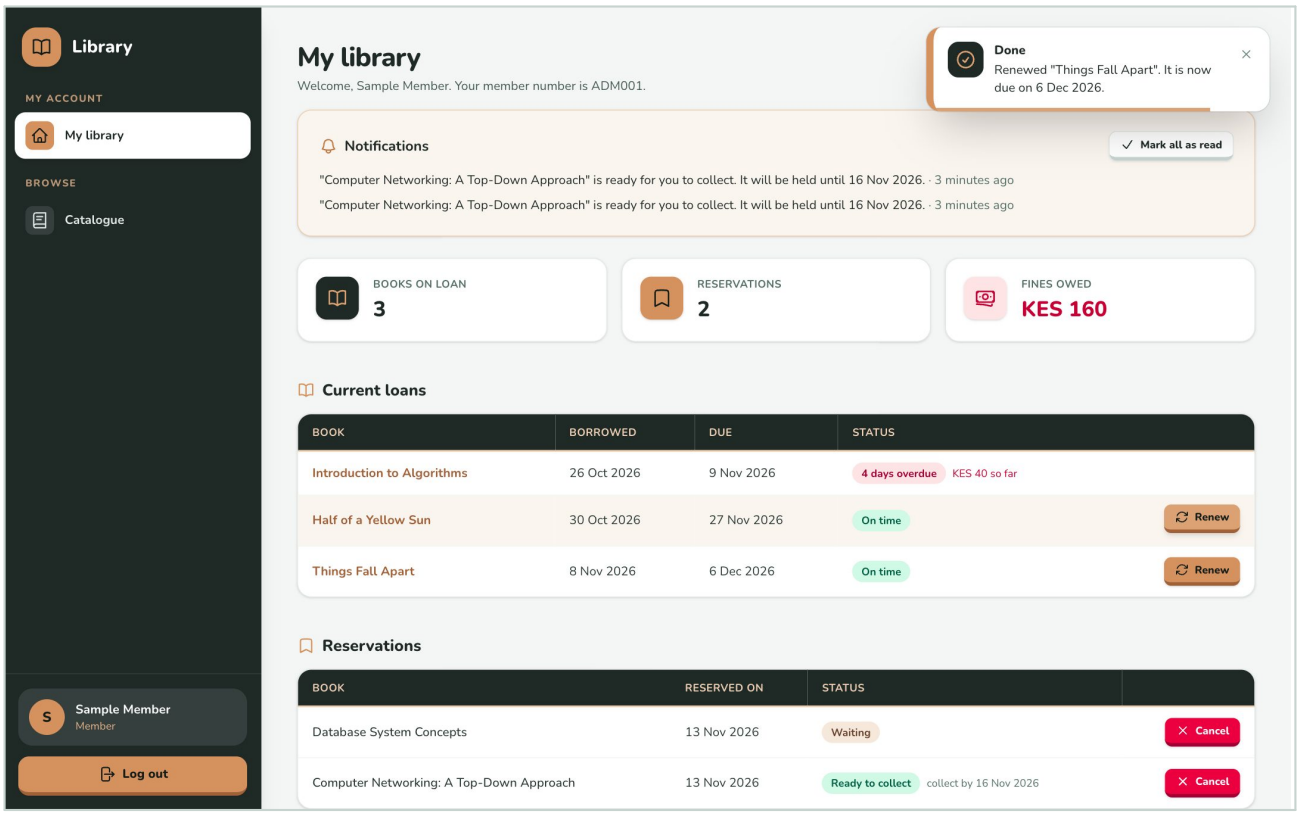


Figure 4: A success toast after renewing a loan

When a library rule blocks an action, an error toast explains why in plain language, for example that the member has reached their borrowing limit. Nothing is changed when an error toast appears.

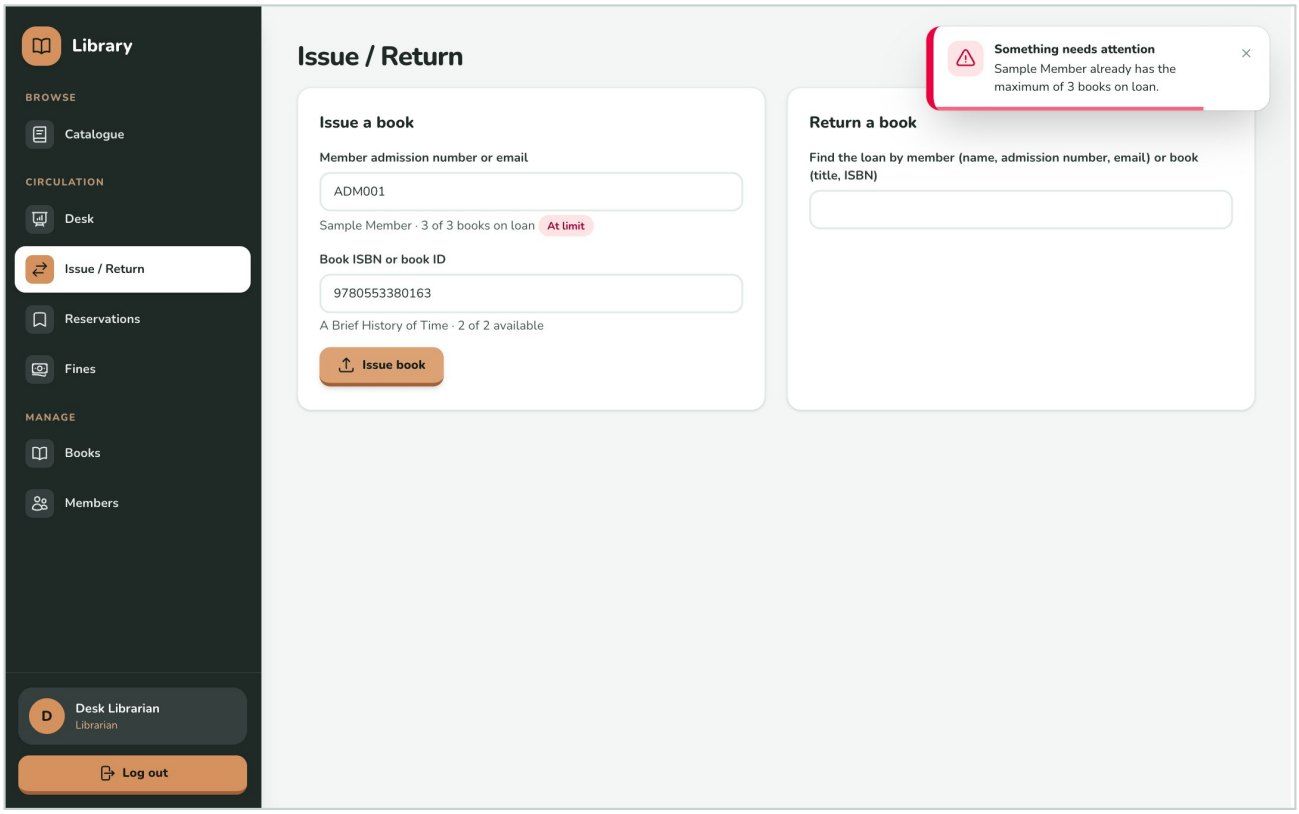


Figure 5: An error toast: the member already has the maximum number of books

3.4 Using the system on a phone

On small screens the sidebar is tucked away. Tap **Menu** at the top right to slide it in; tap outside it, the **×** button, or press Esc to close it. Tables that are wider than the screen scroll sideways inside their own box.

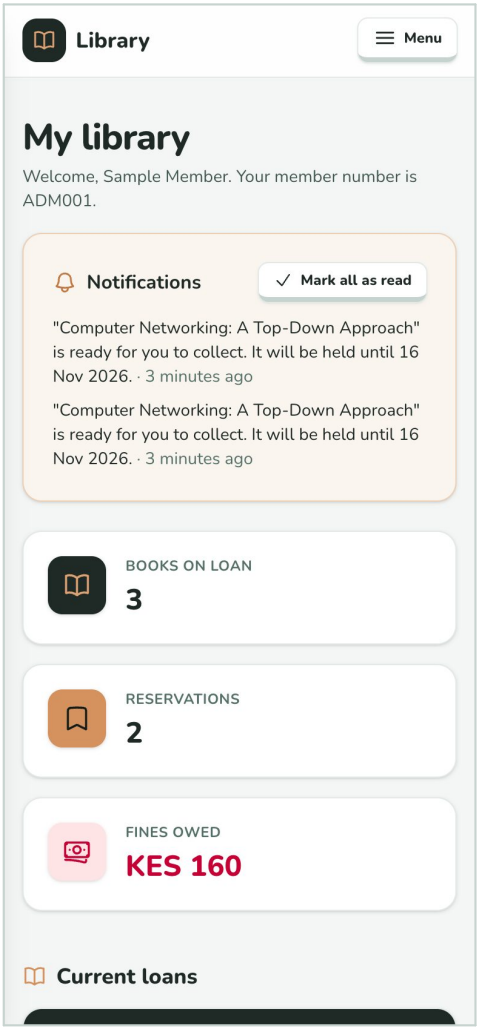


Figure 6: My library on a phone

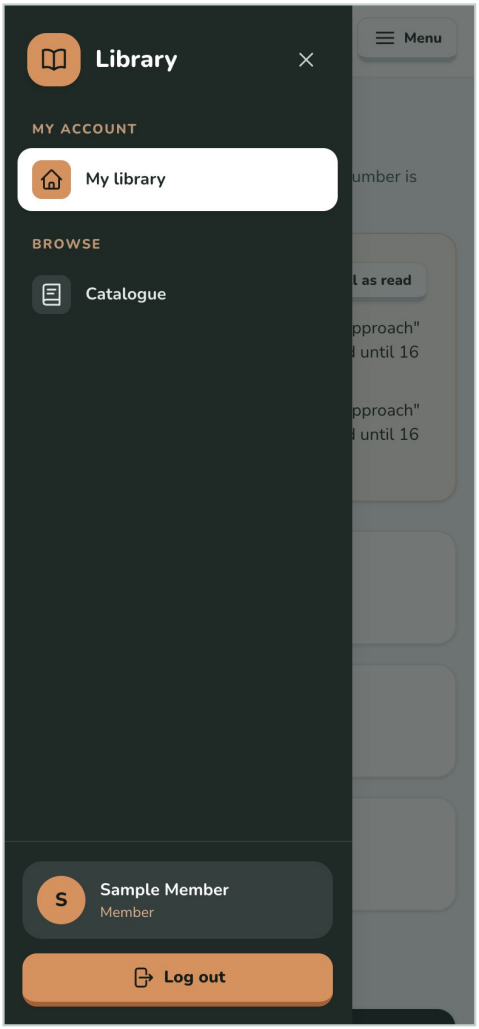


Figure 7: The sidebar opened from Menu

CHAPTER 4

4. Member guide

Members are students and staff who borrow books. Their home page is **My library**.

4.1 My library

My library brings together everything a member needs to know about their borrowing:

- **Notifications**: reminders that a book is due soon or overdue, and that a reserved book is ready to collect. **Mark all as read** clears them.
- **Summary cards**: books on loan, active reservations and the total fines owed (shown in red when money is owed).
- **Current loans**: each book with its borrowed and due dates and a status badge. Overdue loans also show the fine building up so far.
- **Reservations**: books the member is waiting for, and those ready to collect with the collect-by date.
- **Fines**: unpaid fines for books that were returned late. Fines are paid at the librarian's desk.

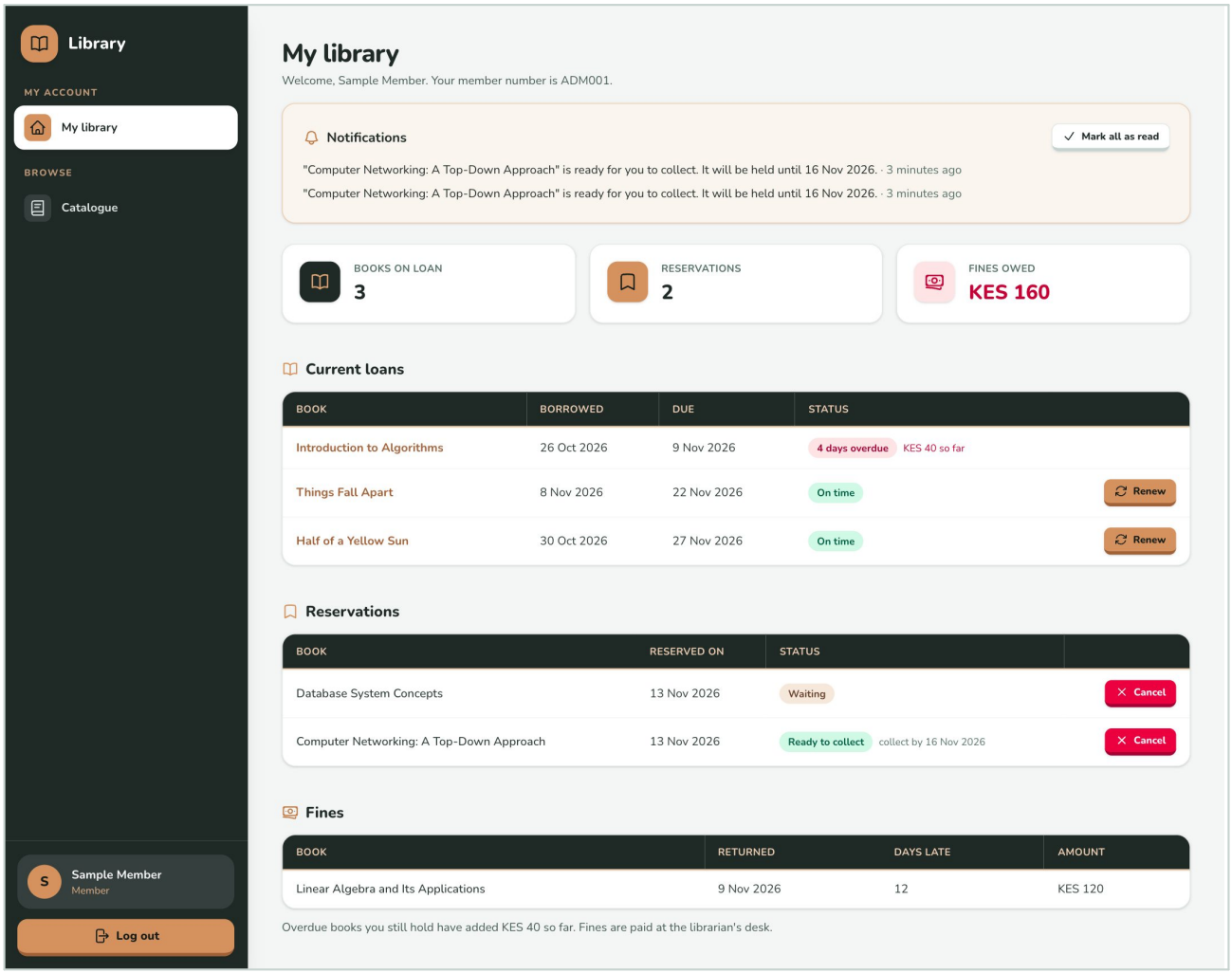


Figure 8: My library: notifications, summary cards, loans, reservations and fines

4.2 Renewing a loan

Click **Renew** next to a loan to extend it by one loan period (14 days by default), counted from the current due date. A renewal is refused, with an explanation, when:

- the book is already overdue (the Renew button is hidden for overdue loans),
- another member has reserved the book, or
- the loan has already been renewed the maximum number of times (2 by default).

4.3 Searching the catalogue

Open **Catalogue** from the sidebar. Results update as you type.

- Type part of a **title**, **author** or **ISBN** into the search box.
- Choose a **category** to narrow the list.
- Tick **Available now** to hide books with no copy on the shelf.

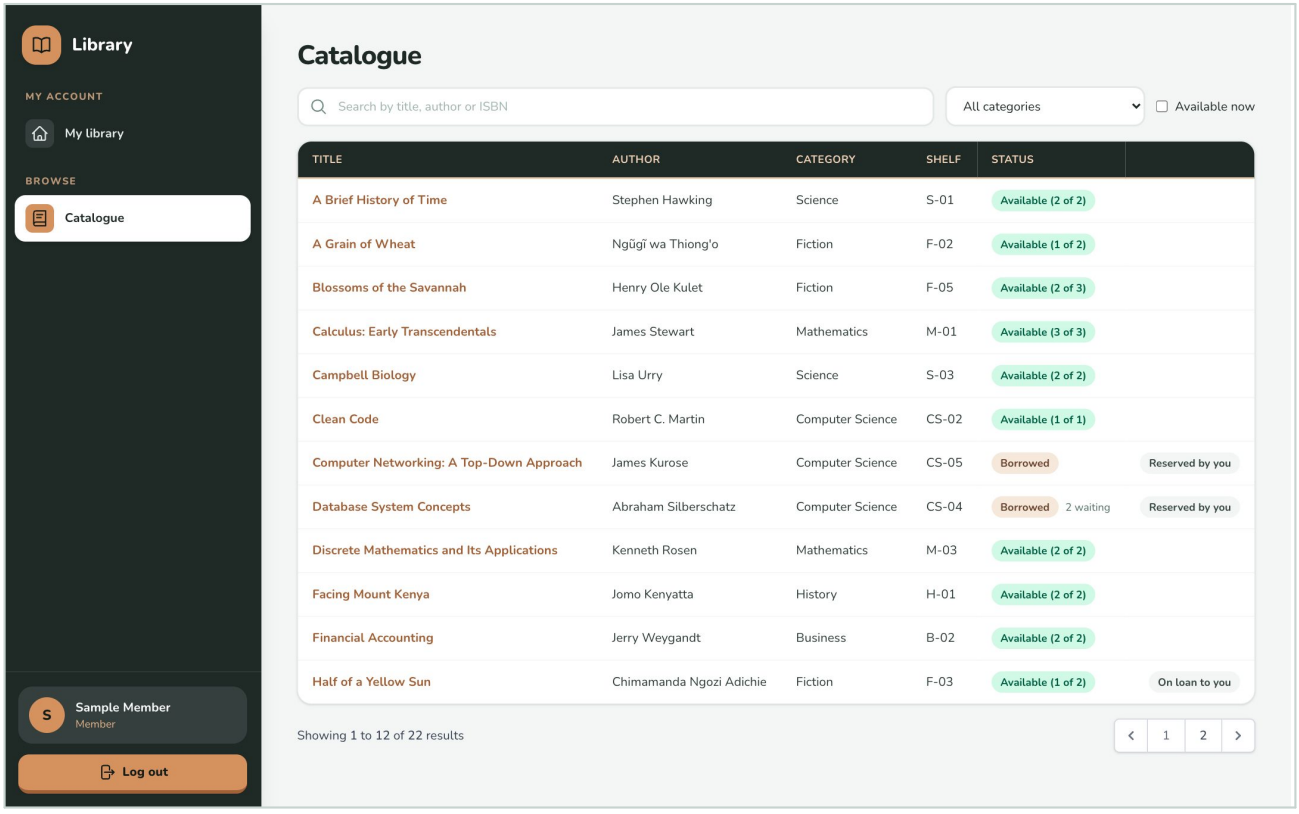


Figure 9: The catalogue with availability and actions for each book

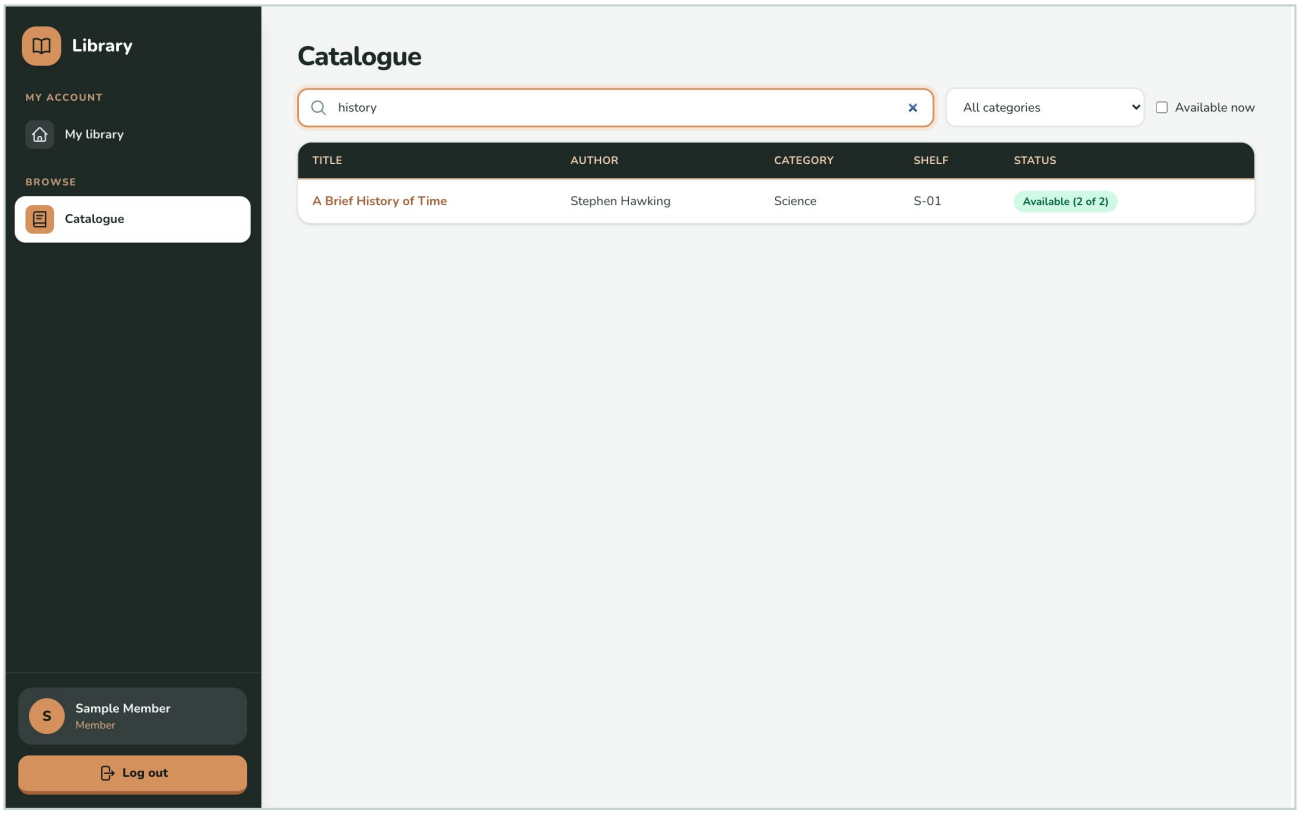


Figure 10: Searching the catalogue for "history"

4.4 Book details

Click a title to see its ISBN, category, shelf location, how many copies are available, how many members are waiting, and when the next copy is due back.

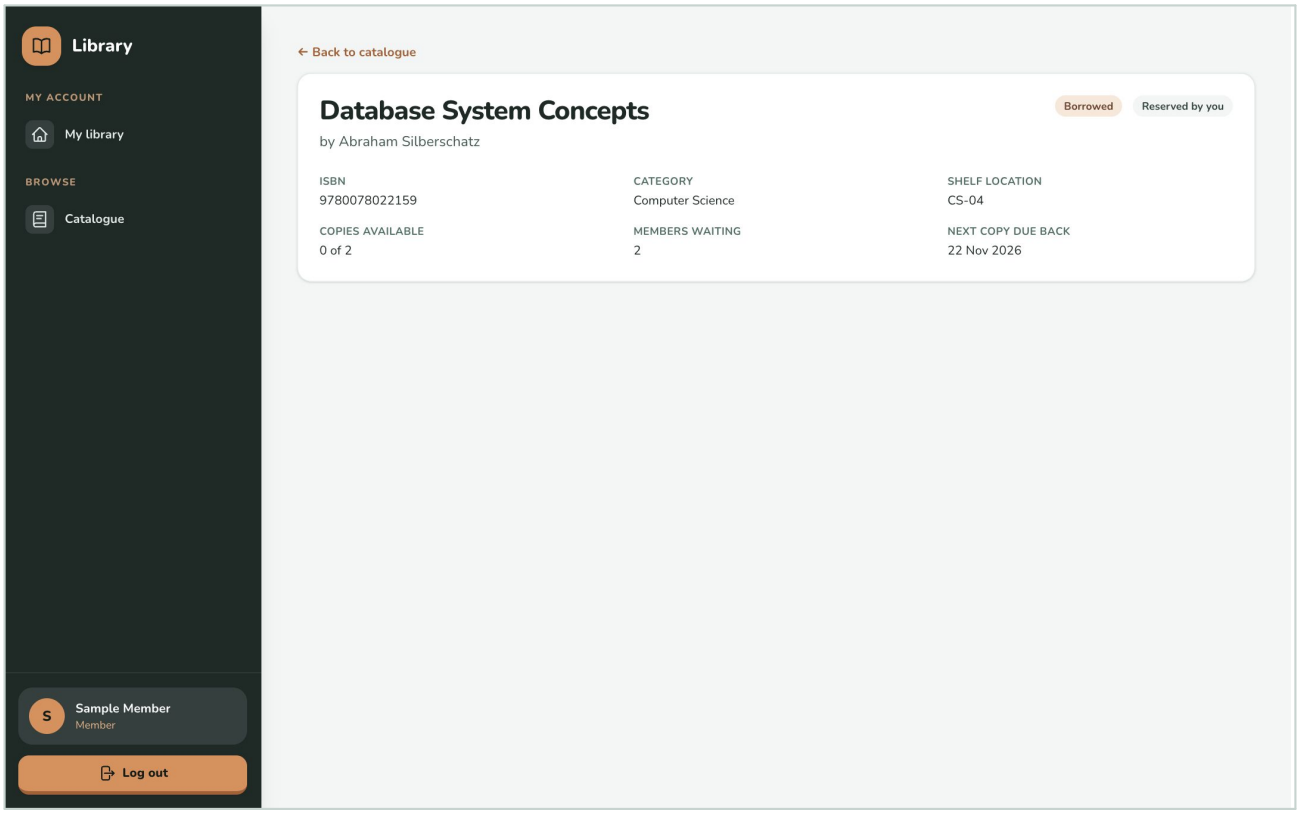


Figure 11: Book details with live availability

4.5 Reserving a book

When every copy of a book is on loan or held for someone else, a **Reserve** button appears. Reserving puts the member in a first-come, first-served queue. When a copy is returned it is held for the member at the front of the queue, who receives a notification and an email. The member must collect it before the hold expires (3 days by default) or the copy passes to the next person.

> A member can hold only one active reservation per book, and cannot reserve a book that has a copy on the shelf. In that case they simply go to the desk and borrow it.

A reservation can be cancelled at any time from My library with the red **Cancel** button.

CHAPTER 5

5. Librarian guide

Librarians run the circulation desk: issuing and returning books, managing the catalogue and member accounts, handling reservations and taking fine payments. Their home page is the **Desk**.

5.1 The desk dashboard

The desk shows the day's work at a glance:

- **Books on loan**, **Due today**, **Overdue** and **Unpaid fines** summary cards.
- **Due back today**: who should be returning what.
- **Overdue**: every late loan with days late and the fine so far.
- **Reserved copies waiting for collection**: copies on the hold shelf and the date each hold ends.
- Quick **Issue book** and **Return book** buttons that open the circulation screen.

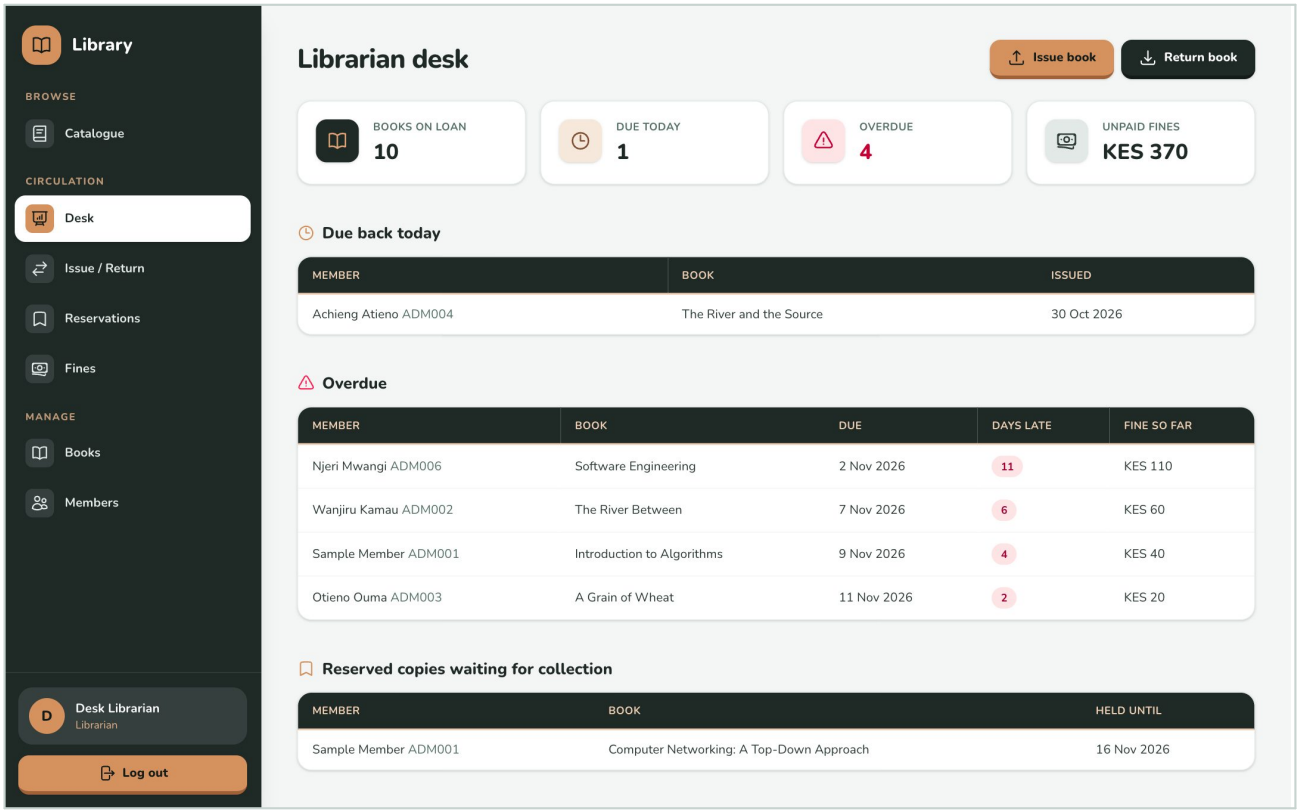


Figure 12: The librarian desk dashboard

5.2 Issuing a book

1. Open **Issue / Return**.
2. Type the member's **admission number or email**. The member's name and how many books they have out appear underneath; a red **At limit** badge warns if they cannot borrow more.
3. Type the book's **ISBN or book ID**. The title and the number of available copies appear underneath.
4. Click **Issue book**. A toast confirms the due date.

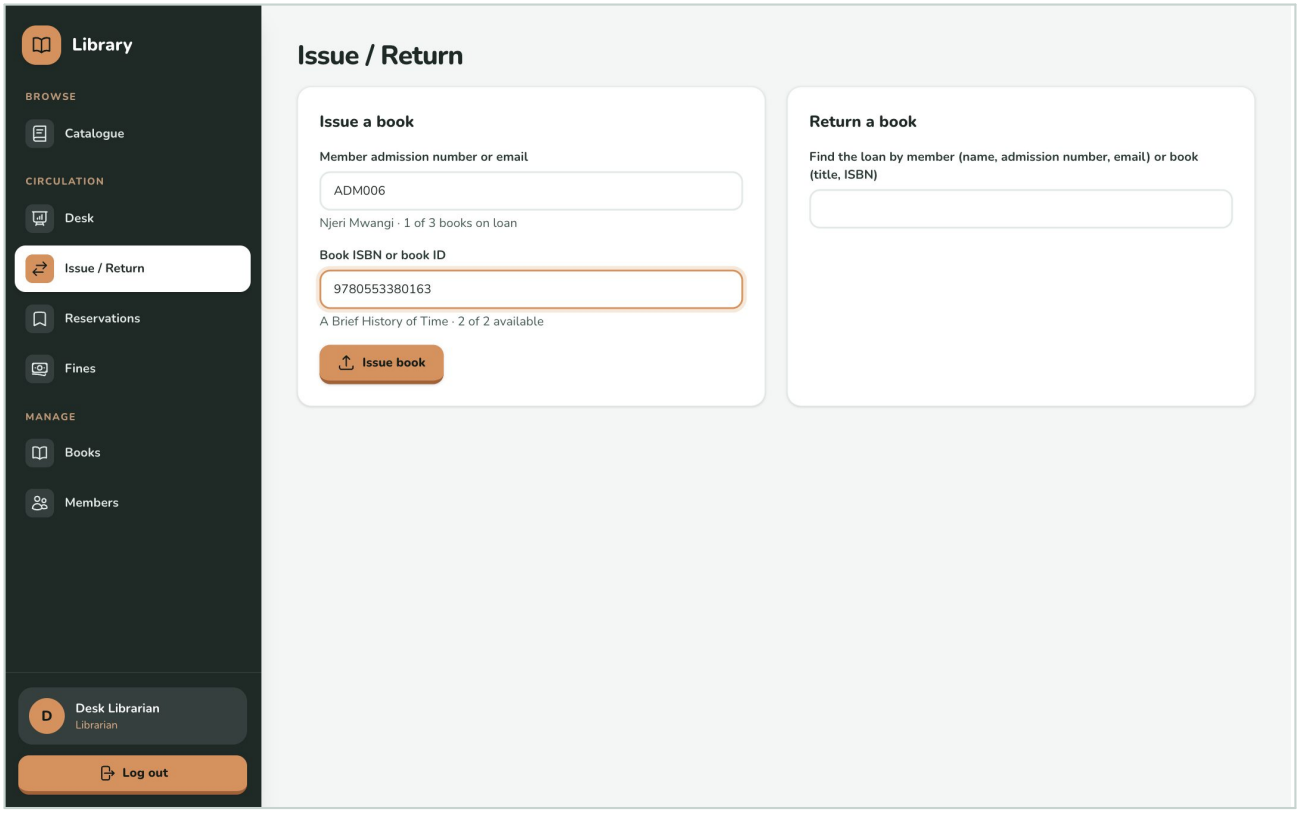


Figure 13: Issuing a book: the member and book are checked before confirming

The loan is refused, with an error toast, when the member is at their limit, already has a copy of the same book, or no copy is available. A copy that is held for a reservation can only be issued to the member it is held for. Issuing a book to a member who reserved it marks the reservation as collected.

5.3 Returning a book

1. On **Issue / Return**, type into **Return a book**: the member's name, admission number or email, or the book's title or ISBN.
2. Matching loans are listed, with any fine that will be charged shown before you confirm.
3. Click **Return**. If the book is late, a fine is created automatically and the toast states the amount.

If other members are waiting for the book, the returned copy is placed on hold for the first in the queue and they are notified straight away.

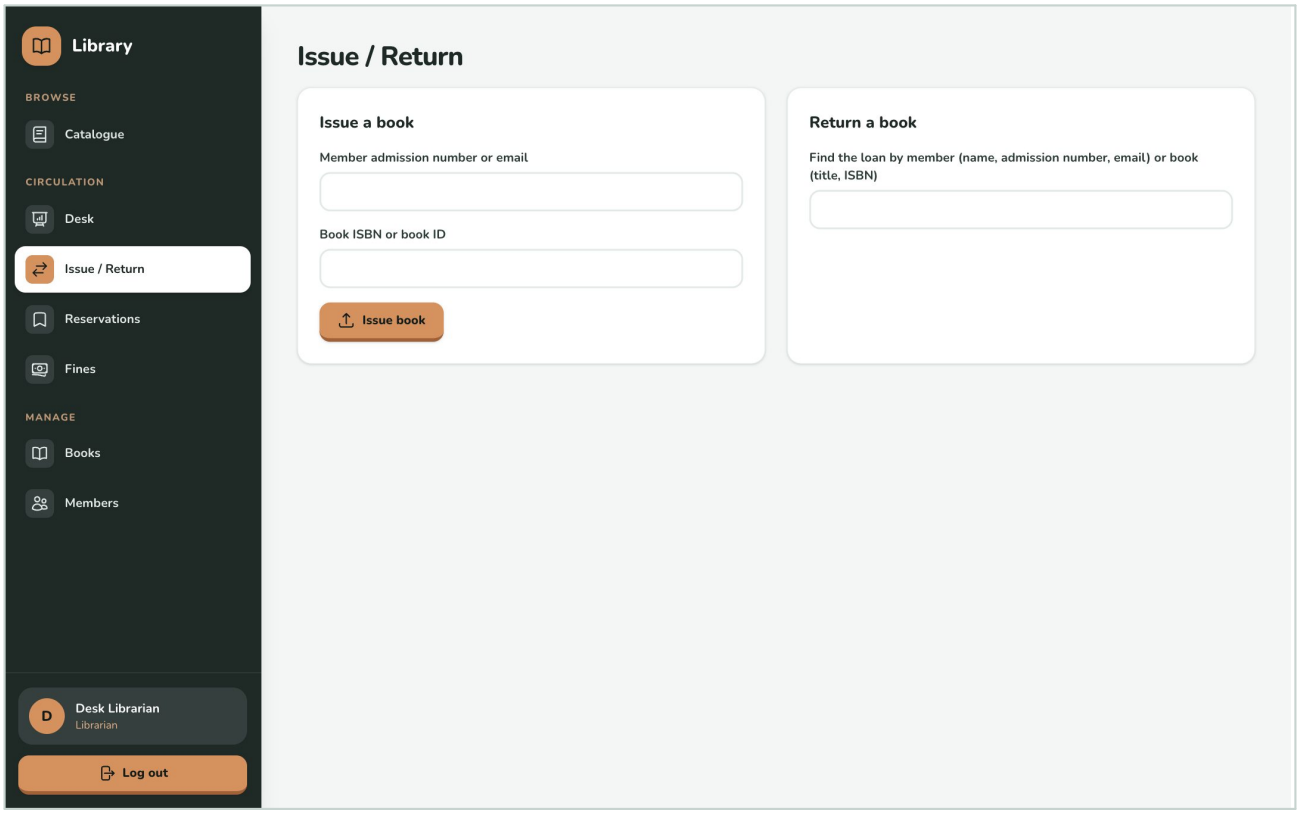


Figure 14: The Issue / Return screen

5.4 Managing books

The **Books** page lists the whole catalogue with ID, title, author, ISBN, category, shelf and available copies. From here a librarian can:

- **Add book**: enter title, author, ISBN, shelf location, category and number of copies. A new category can be added inline.
- **Edit**: change any detail, including the number of copies.
- **Remove**: hide a book from the catalogue. This is blocked while copies are on loan, keeps the loan history, and cancels the book's open reservations.

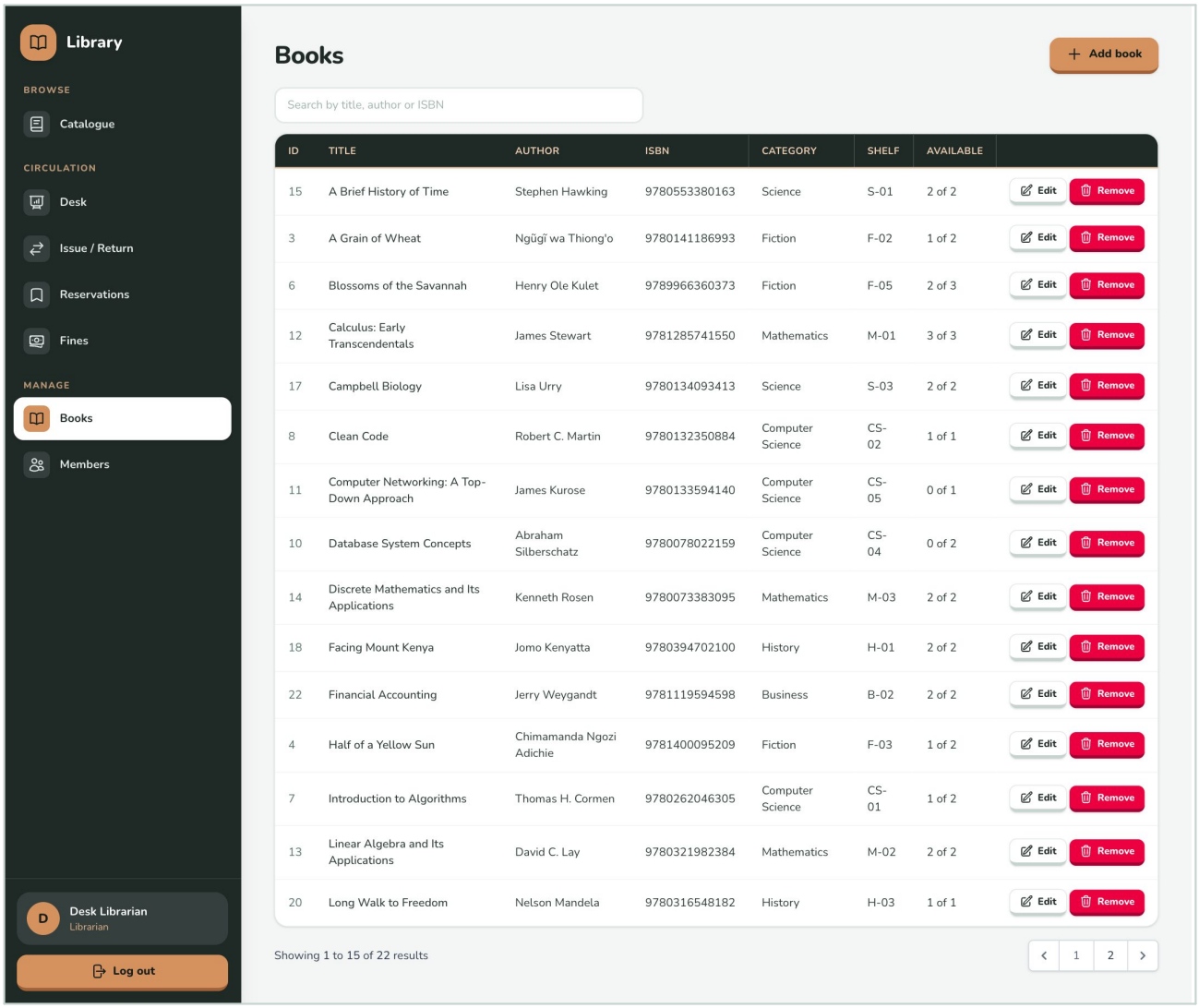


Figure 15: Book management

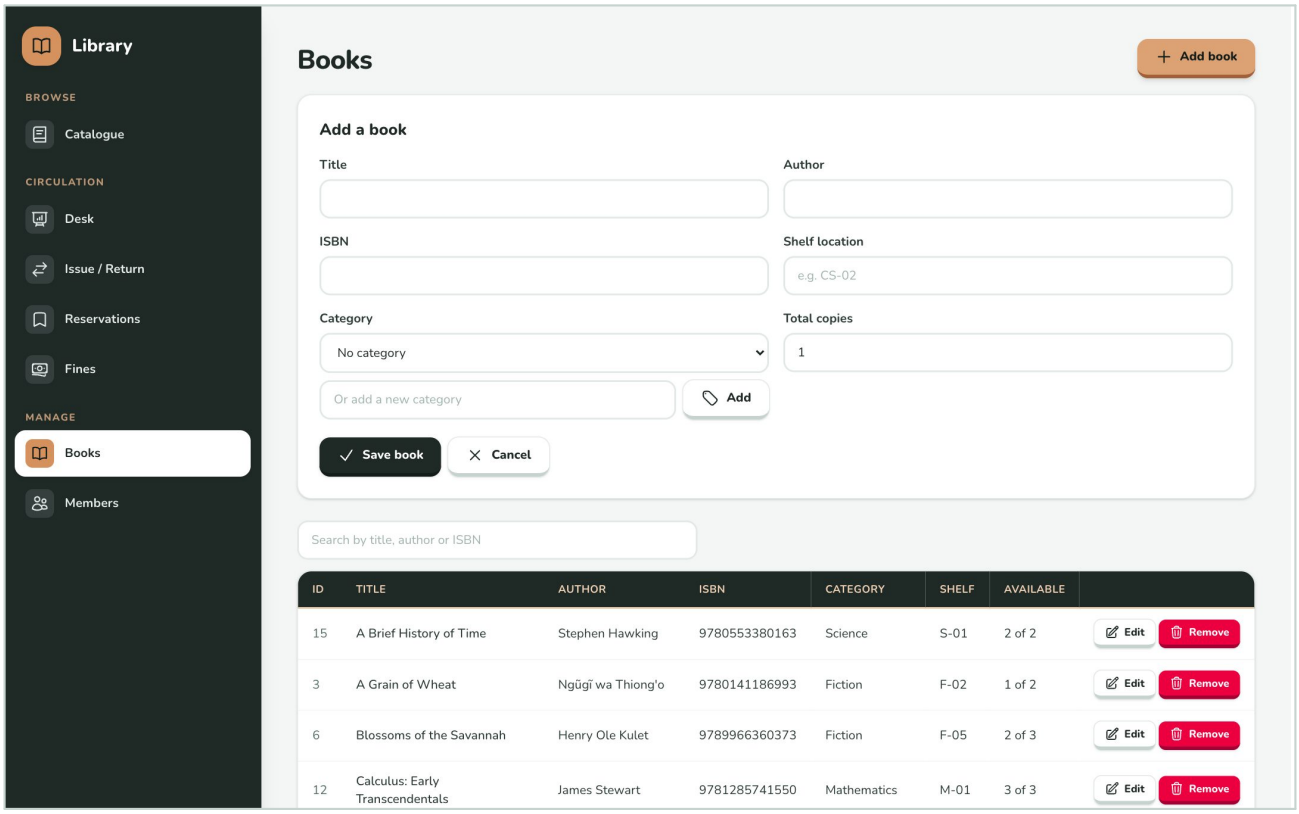


Figure 16: Adding a new book

5.5 Managing members

The **Members** page lists every member with their admission number, email, books on loan and fines owed. **Register member** creates an account at the desk; **Edit** updates details or sets a new password; **Issue book** jumps to the circulation screen with the member already filled in.

> Librarians can edit member accounts only. Staff accounts are managed by an administrator, and member accounts cannot be deleted so that loan and fine history is never lost.

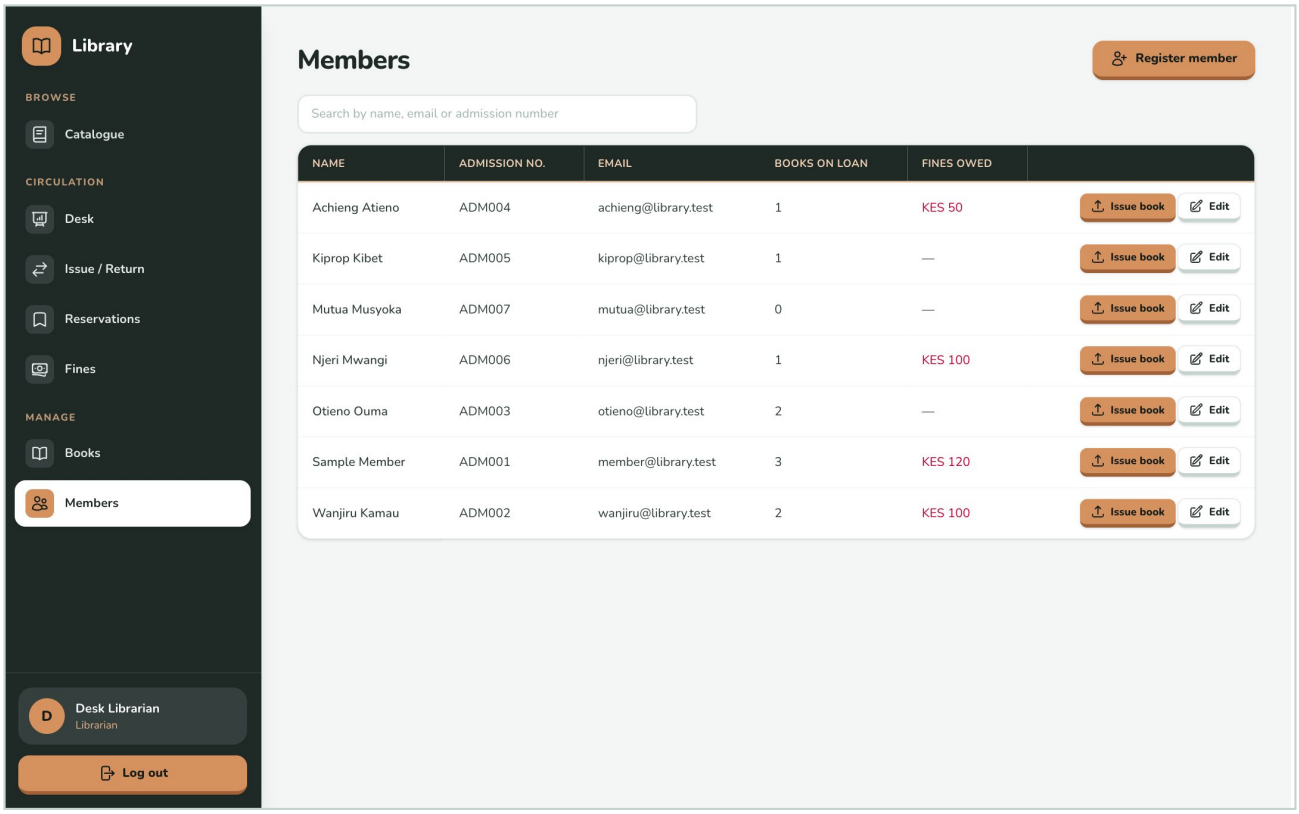


Figure 17: Member management

5.6 Reservations

The **Reservations** page lists open reservations with the book, member, date reserved and status. Copies that are **ready** show the collect-by date and an **Issue** button that opens the circulation screen with the member and book filled in. A reservation can be cancelled; if it was holding a copy, that copy passes to the next member waiting.

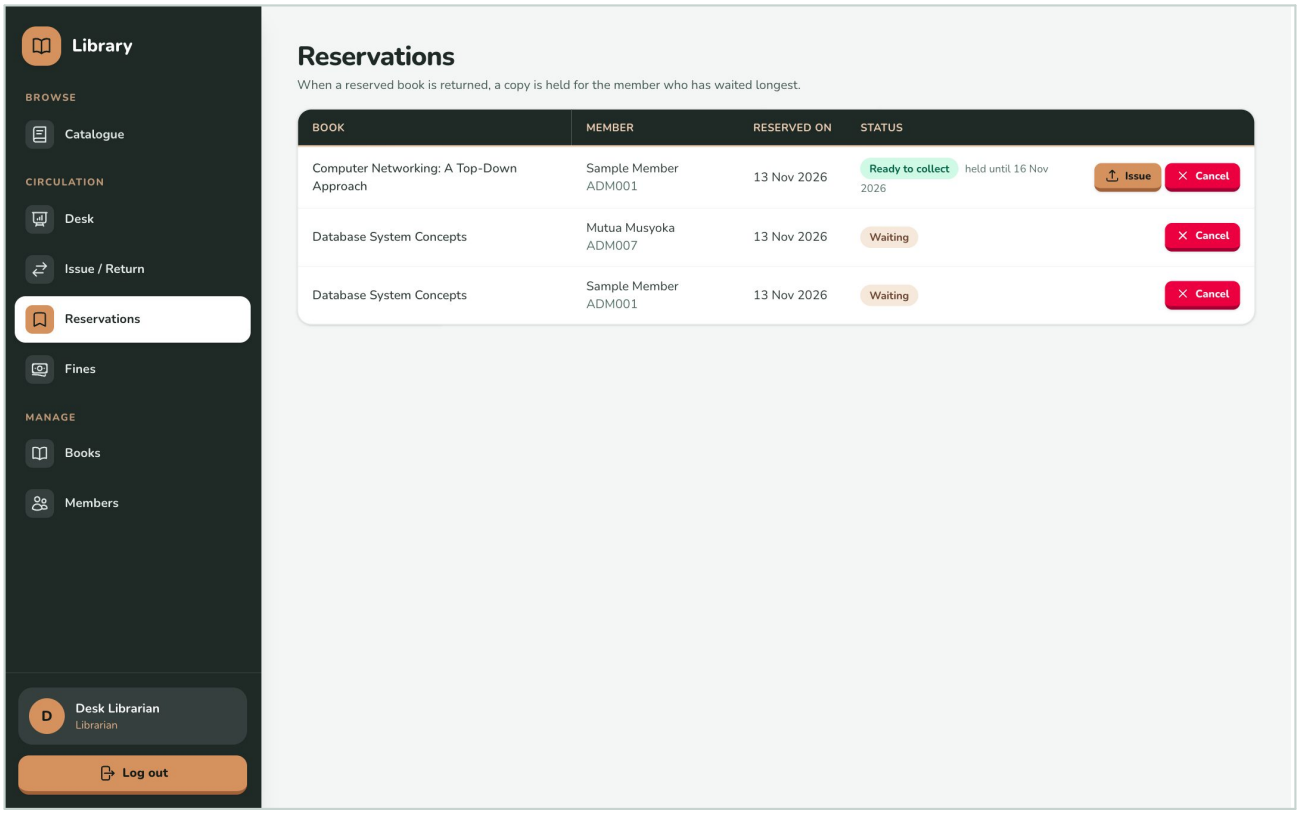


Figure 18: The reservation queue

5.7 Fines and payments

The **Fines** page lists fines with the member, book, return date, amount and status, and shows the total unpaid at the top. Search by member name, email or admission number, and filter to **Unpaid**, **Paid** or **All fines**. When a member pays at the desk, click **Record payment**; the system stores who received the payment and when.

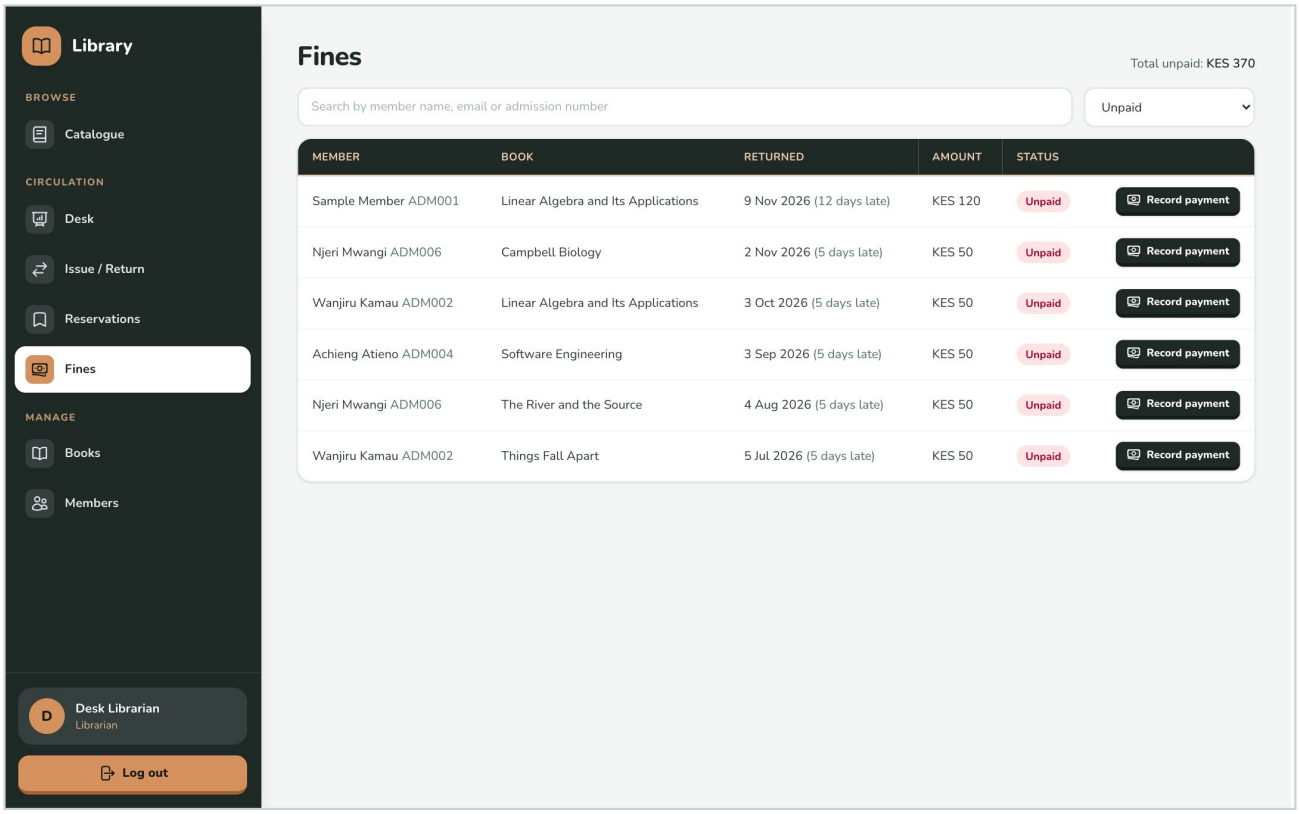


Figure 19: Fines and payments

CHAPTER 6

6. Administrator guide

Administrators can do everything a librarian can, and also manage librarian accounts, set the library rules and view reports. Their home page is **Reports**.

6.1 Reports

The reports page summarises the library:

- Totals for titles, copies, members and books on loan.
- **Most borrowed books**: the ten titles borrowed most often, as bars.
- **Loans issued per month**: a column chart of recent months.
- **Fines**: collected this month, collected in total, charged but unpaid, and building up on overdue books.
- **Overdue books**: every late loan with member, due date, days late and fine so far.

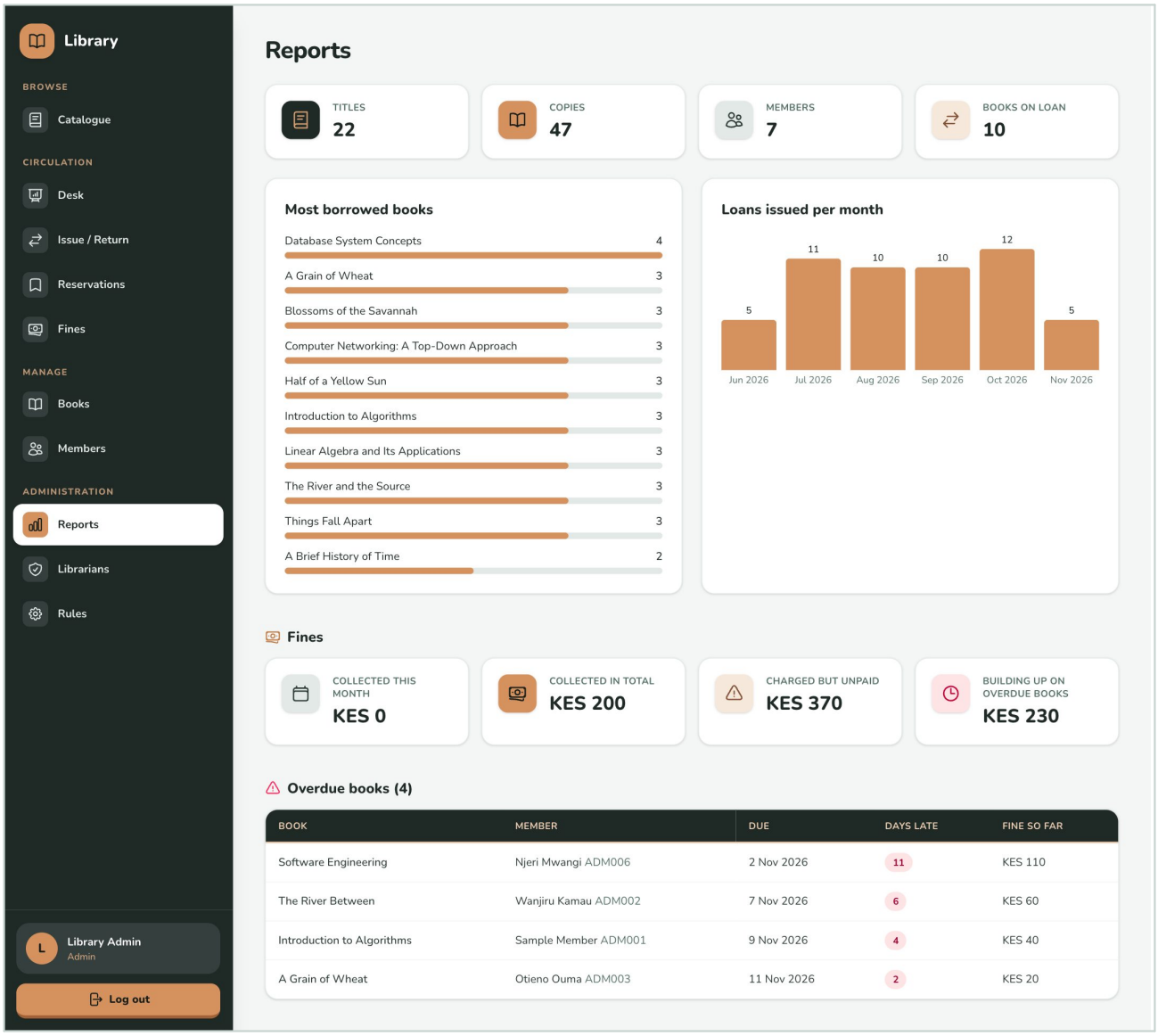


Figure 20: The reports page

6.2 Librarian accounts

Add librarian creates a staff account with a name, email and password. **Edit** changes the details or sets a new password. **Remove access** turns the account back into an ordinary member: it can no longer use the desk, but the history of the loans that person issued is kept.

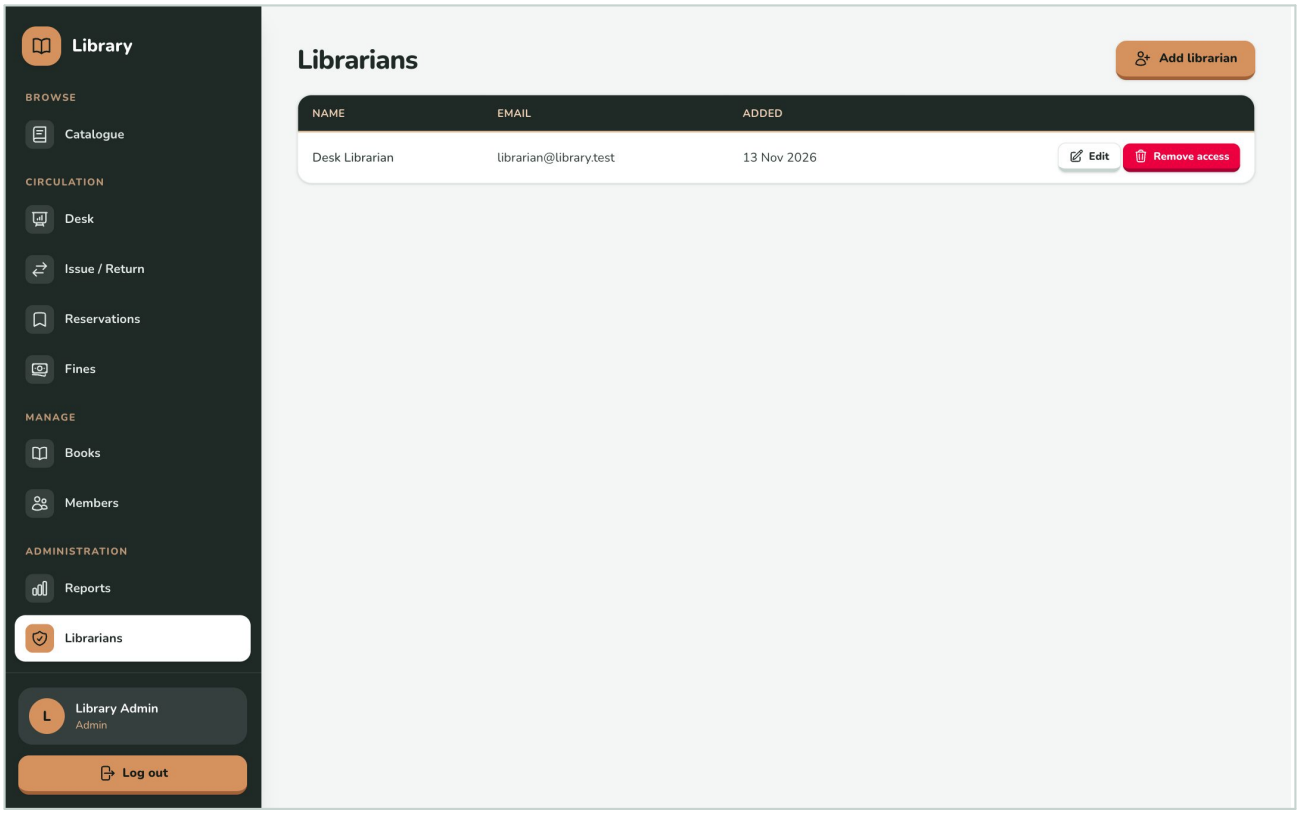


Figure 21: Managing librarian accounts

6.3 Library rules

The **Rules** page sets how the library lends. Changes take effect on the next loan, return or renewal; existing due dates are not changed.

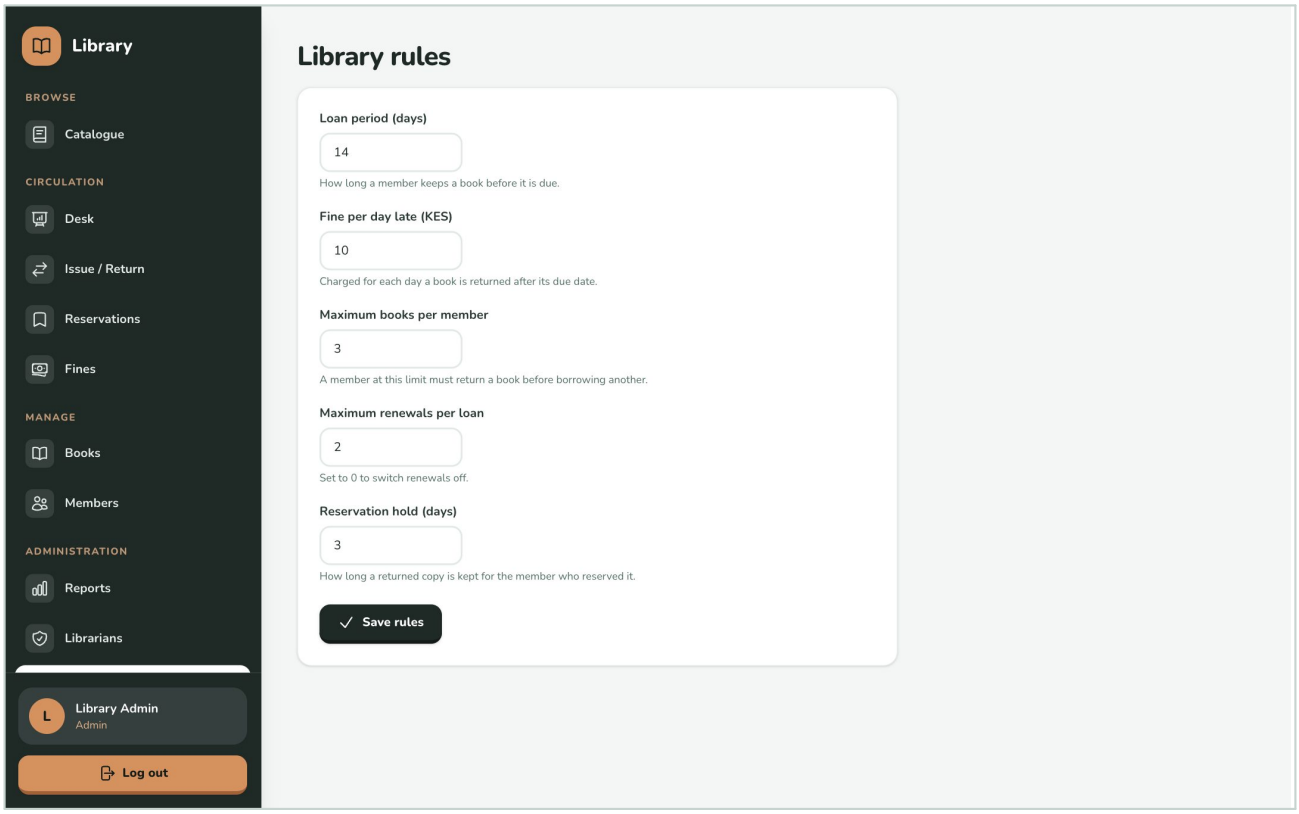


Figure 22: The library rules page

CHAPTER 7

7. Library rules and how lending works

All lending rules live in one service class, `app/Services/LoanService.php`. When a rule blocks an action the service raises a `LoanException` whose message is shown to the person at the screen as an error toast.

7.1 Configurable rules

Rule	Setting key	Default	Effect
Loan period	loan_days	14 days	Due date = issue date + loan period. Also the length of each renewal.
Fine per day late	fine_per_day	KES 10	Charged for each whole day a book is returned after its due date.
Maximum books per member	max_books	3	A member at this limit must return a book before borrowing another.
Maximum renewals per loan	max_renewals	2	Set to 0 to switch renewals off.
Reservation hold period	hold_days	3 days	How long a returned copy is kept for the member who reserved it.

7.2 Availability

Copies are tracked as a count per book. Availability is calculated live from loans and reservations every time, so it can never drift out of step:

```
available copies = total copies - copies on loan - copies held for reservations
```

7.3 Fines

```
fine = whole days past the due date x fine per day
```

- A book returned on its due date carries no fine.
- While a late book is still out, the amount building up is shown as "so far" but no fine record exists yet.
- The fine is created when the book is returned and stays unpaid until a librarian records the payment.

7.4 Reservation life cycle

Status	Meaning	Moves to
pending (Waiting)	Waiting for a copy to come back	ready, cancelled
ready (Ready to collect)	A copy is held on the shelf for the member	fulfilled, cancelled, expired
fulfilled	The member collected the book	-
cancelled	Cancelled by the member or a librarian	-
expired	The held copy was not collected in time	-

When a *ready* reservation is cancelled or expires, the held copy passes to the next member waiting, who is notified.

7.5 Removing records

- Removing a book hides it from the catalogue but keeps its loan history (soft delete). It is blocked while copies are on loan.
- Removing a librarian's access turns the account into a member, keeping the record of loans they issued.
- Member accounts are never deleted from the interface.

CHAPTER 8

8. Roles and permissions

Access is controlled with three roles built on spatie/laravel-permission. Roles and their permissions are defined in one place, `app/Enums/Role.php`.

8.1 Permission matrix

Permission	Allows	Member	Librarian	Admin
catalogue.view	Search and view the catalogue	Yes	Yes	Yes
reservations.create	Reserve a book	Yes	Yes	Yes
loans.renew-own	Renew own loans	Yes	Yes	Yes
fines.view-own	See own fines	Yes	Yes	Yes
books.manage	Add, edit and remove books		Yes	Yes
loans.issue	Issue books; open the desk		Yes	Yes
loans.return	Return books		Yes	Yes
reservations.manage	View and cancel any reservation		Yes	Yes
members.manage	Register and edit members		Yes	Yes
fines.record-payment	Record fine payments		Yes	Yes
librarians.manage	Manage librarian accounts			Yes
settings.manage	Change library rules			Yes
reports.view	View reports			Yes

8.2 How access is enforced

- Every route is protected by `role:` or `permission:` middleware in `routes/web.php`.
- Every staff and admin screen checks its permission again with `Gate::authorize()` when it renders and inside each action, because a Livewire action can be called without visiting the page.
- Member actions look records up through the signed-in user, so one member cannot renew or cancel another member's records.
- The sidebar only shows the links a person's role can open.

After changing the permissions in the Role enum, apply them with:

```
php artisan db:seed --class=RolesAndPermissionsSeeder
```

CHAPTER 9

9. Technical reference

This chapter is for developers and IT staff who maintain the system.

9.1 Technology stack

Layer	Technology
Framework	Laravel 13 on PHP 8.4
User interface	Livewire 4 class-based components with Blade views; Alpine.js for the sidebar drawer and toasts
Styling	Tailwind CSS 4 built with Vite; Nunito font; brand palette defined in resources/css/app.css
Roles and permissions	spatie/laravel-permission 8
Database	SQLite by default; any database Laravel supports
Notifications	Laravel notifications over the database and mail channels
Tests	PHPUnit 12 with Livewire testing helpers

9.2 Architecture

The application follows a simple layered structure. Livewire components handle each screen and call one service for every lending rule, so the rules are tested and enforced in a single place.

Browser	Livewire screens	LoanService	Eloquent models	Database
Pages, sidebar, toasts	One component per screen; authorises every action	Issue, return, renew, reserve, fines	User, Book, Loan, Reservation, Fine, Setting	SQLite / MySQL / PostgreSQL

Requests flow left to right; each layer only talks to its neighbour.

9.3 Project structure

```
app/
  Console/Commands/RunDailyLibraryTasks.php   The library:daily command
  Enums/Role.php                              Roles, permissions and home pages
  Enums/ReservationStatus.php                 Reservation states
  Exceptions/LoanException.php                Raised when a rule blocks an action
  Livewire/
    Auth/                                     Login, Register
    Catalogue/                                Index (search), Show (details)
    Member/Dashboard.php                      My library
    Librarian/                                Dashboard, IssueReturn, Books,
                                              Members, Reservations, Fines
    Admin/                                    Reports, Librarians, Settings
    Concerns/Flashes.php                      Toast messages shared by screens
```

```
  Models/                              User, Book, Category, Loan,
                                       Reservation, Fine, Setting
  Notifications/                       LoanDueSoon, LoanOverdue,
                                       ReservationReady
  Services/LoanService.php             All lending rules
resources/
  css/app.css                          Brand colours and components
  views/layouts/                       app (sidebar) and guest layouts
  views/components/                    icon, nav-link, stat, flash (toast)
  views/livewire/                      One Blade view per screen
routes/web.php                         Pages and their access rules
routes/console.php                     The daily schedule
tests/Feature/                         Feature tests
```

9.4 Screens and URLs

URL	Screen	Who
/login, /register	Sign in, create a member account	Guests
/dashboard	Redirects to the role's home page	Everyone
/member	My library	Members
/catalogue	Catalogue search	Everyone
/catalogue/{book}	Book details	Everyone
/librarian	Desk dashboard	Librarian, Admin
/librarian/circulation	Issue and return	Librarian, Admin
/librarian/books	Book management	Librarian, Admin
/librarian/members	Member management	Librarian, Admin
/librarian/reservations	Reservation queue	Librarian, Admin
/librarian/fines	Fines and payments	Librarian, Admin
/admin/reports	Reports	Admin
/admin/librarians	Librarian accounts	Admin
/admin/settings	Library rules	Admin

9.5 Interface components

Component	Purpose
<x-icon name="...">	Inline outline icons (home, books, desk, arrows, users, bookmark, banknotes, chart, shield, cog and more). Decorative and hidden from screen readers.
<x-nav-link>	A sidebar link with an icon; marks the current page with aria-current.
<x-stat>	A summary card with a coloured icon tile (ink, copper, sage, sand or rose).
<x-flash>	Renders the screen's notice or failure as an auto-dismissing toast.
.btn, .btn-primary, .btn-dark, .btn-secondary, .btn-danger, .btn-sm	Chunky button styles defined in resources/css/app.css.

CHAPTER 10

10. Data model

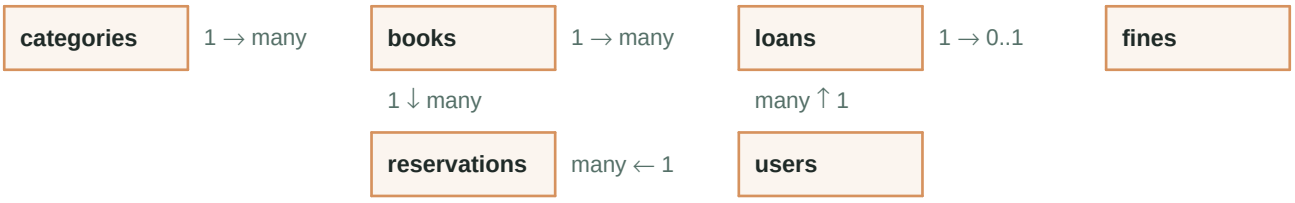
Amounts are stored as whole Kenyan shillings. Book removal uses soft deletes so history is kept.

10.1 Tables

Table	Purpose	Key columns
users	Members, librarians and admins	name, email, admission_number, password
categories	Book categories	name
books	The catalogue	title, author, isbn, category_id, shelf_location, total_copies, deleted_at
loans	Every check-out	user_id, book_id, issued_by, issued_at, due_at, returned_at, renewals_count
reservations	The waiting queue	user_id, book_id, status, ready_at, expires_at
fines	Late-return charges	loan_id, user_id, amount, paid_at, received_by
settings	Library rules	key, value
notifications	In-app notifications	Laravel's standard table
roles, permissions and pivots	Access control	Managed by spatie/laravel-permission

10.2 Relationships

- A **book** belongs to one category and has many loans and reservations.
- A **loan** belongs to a member, a book and the librarian who issued it, and has at most one fine.
- A **fine** belongs to a loan and a member, and records the librarian who received payment.
- A **reservation** belongs to a member and a book and moves through the life cycle in chapter 7.



Main entities and how they relate

CHAPTER 11

11. Notifications and scheduled tasks

11.1 Notifications

Notification	Sent when	Channels
LoanDueSoon	The day before a book is due	In-app and email
LoanOverdue	On the first day late, then every seventh day	In-app and email
ReservationReady	A reserved copy is placed on hold for the member	In-app and email

In-app notifications appear at the top of My library. With the default `MAIL_MAILER=log` emails are written to `storage/logs/laravel.log`; set the `MAIL_*` values in `.env` to deliver real email.

11.2 The daily task

One command does the daily housekeeping: it releases held copies that were not collected (passing them to the next member), sends due-tomorrow reminders and sends overdue reminders.

```
php artisan library:daily
```

It is scheduled for 07:00 every day in `routes/console.php`. The schedule only runs while a scheduler is running. During development use `php artisan schedule:work`; on a server add the standard cron entry:

```
* * * * * cd /path/to/library && php artisan schedule:run >> /dev/null 2>&1
```

CHAPTER 12

12. Security, testing and support

12.1 Security measures

- Passwords are hashed by Laravel; they are never stored or shown in plain text.
- Sign-in is rate limited: five failed attempts lock the form for a short time.
- Every page and every action checks the person's role or permission (chapter 8).
- All forms are protected against cross-site request forgery; signing out invalidates the session.
- Member records are always looked up through the signed-in member, so one member cannot act on another's records.

12.2 Automated tests

The test suite uses an in-memory SQLite database. Run it with:

```
php artisan test
```

Test file	What it checks
AuthenticationTest	Sign-in by email and admission number, wrong password, registration, sign-out
RoleAccessTest	Each role is sent to its own home page
PagesTest	Every page opens only for the roles allowed to use it
LoanServiceTest	Borrowing limit, availability, held copies, late fines, renewals, the queue, hold expiry, payments
ScreenActionsTest	The actions on each screen: search, reserve, books, members, issue, return, renew, rules, librarians
DailyLibraryTasksTest	Due and overdue reminders and expiry of uncollected reservations
SidebarNavigationTest	Each role sees only its sidebar links; active page; user card and log out; phone menu
ToastNotificationsTest	Success and error toasts appear; repeated actions give a fresh toast
InterfaceComponentsTest	The icon, stat card and toast components

Format PHP code before committing with `vendor/bin/pint`.

12.3 Troubleshooting

Problem	Likely cause and fix
Styles look broken or "Unable to locate file in Vite manifest"	Assets are not built. Run `npm run build`, or keep `composer run dev` running.
A member cannot borrow	They are at the borrowing limit, already have that book, or every copy is out or held. The error toast says which.
Renew button missing or renewal refused	The loan is overdue, someone has reserved the book, or the renewal limit is reached.
Reminders are not being sent	No scheduler is running. Start `php artisan schedule:work` or add the cron entry.
Emails do not arrive	MAIL_MAILER is set to log. Configure the MAIL_* settings in .env.
A new permission has no effect	Re-run `php artisan db:seed --class=RolesAndPermissionsSeeder`.
"Too many login attempts"	Wait for the lock-out period shown, then try again with the right details.

12.4 Known limitations

- **No online payment.** Fines are paid at the desk; there is no M-Pesa or card integration.
- **No per-copy barcodes.** Books are issued by ISBN or ID and copies are a count.
- **No self-service password reset or email verification.** A librarian can set a new password for a member, and an administrator for a librarian.
- **Member accounts cannot be deleted** from the interface, so history is never lost.
- **Whole-day fines in one currency** (Kenyan shillings).

CHAPTER 13

13. Appendix: list of figures

Figure	Shows
1	The sign-in screen
2	A failed sign-in shows a clear message under the field
3	The registration screen
4	A success toast after renewing a loan
5	An error toast: the member already has the maximum number of books
6	My library on a phone
7	The sidebar opened from Menu
8	My library: notifications, summary cards, loans, reservations and fines
9	The catalogue with availability and actions for each book
10	Searching the catalogue for "history"
11	Book details with live availability
12	The librarian desk dashboard
13	Issuing a book: the member and book are checked before confirming
14	The Issue / Return screen
15	Book management
16	Adding a new book
17	Member management
18	The reservation queue
19	Fines and payments
20	The reports page
21	Managing librarian accounts
22	The library rules page